

Accessibility Statement

How we try to make upbss usable for everyone, what we know is not yet right, and what to do if we have missed something.

DRAFT FOR LEGAL REVIEW — NOT LEGAL ADVICE. This statement describes the site as currently built and is based on **self-assessment only**. No independent accessibility audit has been carried out and no assistive-technology testing has been done. Do not upgrade the claims below without evidence: overstating accessibility is itself a risk, and a statement that claims full compliance without testing is worse than one that is honest about its gaps.

1. Our commitment

We want everyone to be able to search for a property, request a viewing and contact a person, regardless of how they use the web. Accessibility is treated as part of building a page, not as an audit done afterwards.

2. The legal position

We are a private-sector business. The **Public Sector Bodies (Websites and Mobile Applications) (No. 2) Accessibility Regulations 2018** apply to public sector organisations and therefore do not apply to us.

The **Equality Act 2010** does apply, and it extends to Scotland. As a provider of services to the public we have a duty to make **reasonable adjustments** so that disabled people are not put at a substantial disadvantage. That duty is anticipatory: it is not triggered by a complaint, it exists in advance.

One Scotland-specific point worth knowing: the Home Report **Single Survey includes an accessibility audit** of the property itself. That is a statutory feature of selling in Scotland and is separate from the accessibility of this website, but it means accessibility information is something buyers here expect to be given as standard.

We therefore **aim** to meet **WCAG 2.2 Level AA** as the recognised benchmark, and treat any failure to do so as a defect to be fixed.

Note for review. The previous draft cited WCAG 2.2 AA and implied conformance. Because no audit has been done, this version deliberately says “aim to meet” rather than “meets”. If you want to claim conformance, commission an audit first.

3. What is in place

The following have been built in deliberately and confirmed by inspection of the code:

- A **skip link** on every page, jumping straight to the main content.
- Every interactive control is reachable and operable with a **keyboard**, with a visible focus indicator.

- Form fields have **permanently visible labels** — not placeholder text used as a label — and errors appear next to the field they belong to, in text, with a recovery hint rather than just a red border.
- Native browser validation bubbles are suppressed so every error is reported the same way.
- Decorative icons and the generated property illustrations are hidden from assistive technology, so they are not announced as meaningless images.
- Icon-only buttons carry an accessible name.
- **Animation is reduced or removed** when your system requests reduced motion, including the auto-advancing testimonial carousel, which stops entirely.
- The testimonial carousel also pauses on hover and on keyboard focus, and announces changes to screen readers via a live region.
- Headings follow a logical order, and pages use landmark elements.
- Colour is not used as the only means of conveying information.
- Both a light and a dark theme are provided, and the choice is remembered.
- Page layouts reflow without horizontal scrolling down to a 375 pixel-wide screen, verified by measurement across every main page.

4. Known limitations

We would rather list these than pretend they do not exist:

- **No independent audit has been carried out.** Everything above is self-assessed.
- **No testing with screen readers** or other assistive technology has yet been done. Assessment so far has been code inspection and automated measurement only.
- **Colour contrast has not been formally measured** against the WCAG AA thresholds in either theme. It was designed with contrast in mind, but designed-for is not the same as measured.
- **Text resizing and 200% zoom have not been formally verified** for every page.
- Property images are **generated illustrations rather than photography**, and are marked decorative. The written description carries the same information, but a visitor relying on images will get less from a listing than a sighted visitor.
- PDF documents we publish, including this one, **may not be fully tagged** for screen readers. Ask us and we will provide the content in another format.
- Third-party content, such as property portal feeds or embedded maps, may not meet the same standard once added.

5. Getting content in a different format

If you need anything on this site — a listing, a document, or a form — in large print, plain text, audio, or any other accessible format, contact us and we will provide it. There is no charge.

[\[EMAIL\]](#) · [\[TELEPHONE\]](#)

If completing a form online is difficult, telephone us and a consultant will complete it with you.

6. Telling us about a problem

If you find something that does not work with your assistive technology, please tell us — that report is the most useful thing we can receive. Email [\[EMAIL\]](#) with the page address and what went wrong.

We aim to respond **within 5 working days**, and to fix confirmed issues in the next release. Where a fix will take longer, we will tell you and offer an alternative way to get what you need in the meantime.

7. If you are not happy with our response

If you are unhappy with how we have responded, please use our Complaints Procedure. If you believe we have failed in our duty to make reasonable adjustments under the Equality Act 2010, you can contact the **Equality Advisory and Support Service (EASS)**, which provides free advice to individuals in England, Scotland and Wales. In Northern Ireland, contact the Equality Commission for Northern Ireland.

8. How this statement was prepared

Assessment method	Self-assessment: manual code review and automated layout measurement
Independent audit	None carried out
Assistive technology testing	None carried out
Standard used as a benchmark	WCAG 2.2 Level AA (aimed for, not certified)
Statement prepared	[DATE]
Next review due	[DATE — recommend every 12 months, and after any significant change]

9. Our plan

The next steps we intend to take, in order:

1. Measure colour contrast across both themes and correct any pair below the AA threshold.
2. Test the main journeys — search, listing, enquiry, appraisal — with at least one screen reader.
3. Verify behaviour at 200% zoom and at 400% reflow.
4. Add real alternative text once photography replaces the generated illustrations.
5. Commission an independent audit before any public launch.

upbss — Accessibility Statement. Version 0.2 (draft, Scotland). Last updated [\[DATE\]](#). Written for a private-sector business under the Equality Act 2010, which applies across Great Britain. Claims are deliberately conservative pending an audit.